
Native Languages, Level 4, Open (NL4)

(LNADO–LNODO)

This course will provide students with opportunities to further develop their knowledge of a Native language and of Native philosophy, spirituality, and values, and to enhance their sense of identity and self-worth. Students will increase their vocabulary and improve their facility in using idioms, and will use the Native language to analyse literature, discuss various issues that affect the local community, and exchange information electronically.

Prerequisite: Native Languages, Level 3, Open, or demonstrated proficiency

Oral Communication

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- communicate spontaneously and in a variety of new situations;
- demonstrate an understanding of the vitality of a Native language;
- use specific vocabulary for specific topics;
- understand and use complex language patterns;
- demonstrate an understanding of the concept of citizenship in Native North American culture.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of and respect for Native cultural traditions and arts;
- describe events in literary works;
- interpret written and oral work, with assistance;
- analyse a short story;
- describe the feelings of characters in stories;
- demonstrate an understanding of specific types of figurative language (metaphors);
- demonstrate an understanding of citizenship as it applies to the local community.

Use of Words and Language Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- use simple, compound, and compound-complex sentences to express concepts and ideas;
- use intonations as spoken by a fluent speaker;
- speak confidently and persuasively on a range of topics, both familiar and new;
- describe the concept of citizenship in Native North American culture;
- describe the concept of relationships in Native North American culture (Aboriginal world view).

Reading

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate comprehension of written works;
- read a variety of written works to gather information about cultural perspectives;
- demonstrate an understanding of an Aboriginal world view through an analysis of words;
- use electronic technology to communicate in a Native language with other students.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate comprehension of written works (e.g., using alternative words or phrases, breaking a message into smaller parts) by participating in and producing a language project;
- compare and contrast ideas, characters, and events in written works;
- read a variety of written works for different purposes (e.g., leisure, knowledge, news, facts);
- demonstrate an understanding of Native historical writing (e.g., The Great Law, works by Peter Jones);
- demonstrate an understanding of cosmology (e.g., family, spiritual kinships) through word analysis.

Use of Words and Language Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- read materials orally, using correct pronunciation and with confidence;
- demonstrate an understanding of language patterns after reading a variety of written works;
- demonstrate an understanding of written works by participating in oral language activities (e.g., skits, paraphrasing);
- demonstrate an understanding of new combinations of known language patterns and vocabulary after reading a variety of written works;
- communicate in a Native language to exchange ideas and feelings on social issues (e.g., issues in health, sports; issues from history) with other students, using electronic technology.

Writing

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of language patterns and spelling strategies;
- communicate ideas, feelings, and information;
- produce a variety of written works (e.g., story books, comic strips);
- use appropriate punctuation and appropriate diacritical marks on unfamiliar words;
- use electronic technology to communicate in a Native language with other students.

Specific Expectations

Reasoning and Critical Thinking

By the end of this course, students will:

- demonstrate an understanding of Native cultural traditions and arts through the use of new words and phrases;
- demonstrate their knowledge of different forms of writing (e.g., description, exposition, report, argument, dialogue);
- use varied vocabulary and expressions in conveying facts, opinions, emotions, and ideas electronically to students in other communities;
- demonstrate an awareness of the potential of certain words and phrases to have multiple meanings (e.g., literal and figurative meanings);
- communicate in a Native language to exchange ideas and feelings on social issues (e.g., health issues, the judicial system, rural and urban lifestyles) with other students, using electronic technology.

Use of Words and Language Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- produce a variety of written materials (e.g., short stories, notes, lists, poems, newspaper columns, advertisements);
- produce a script (e.g., dialogue, comic strip);
- demonstrate an understanding of the correct use of language patterns in their writing.

Grammar, Language Conventions, and Vocabulary

Languages reflect the culture and philosophy of the people who speak them. Grammar, which is the framework of language, reveals the ways in which each language defines the relationships between concepts. An understanding of these relationships enhances a speaker's ability to formulate ideas, to communicate, and to understand the communication of others.

In Native languages, individual words carry a great deal of information, much more than is the case in English or French. Effective communication in Native languages, therefore, requires grammatical accuracy.

The learning of grammar can be a productive and enjoyable activity for students. It is not necessary for students to memorize rules of grammar. A knowledge of the structure of a language allows students to analyse and reflect on its use, thereby stimulating their interest in language itself, deepening their understanding of the language being learned, and helping them to develop their writing skills and to analyse the writing of others.

This section supports all three strands in the course. Students should develop and apply the language knowledge through communicative activities in all three strands.

Language elements for the two Native language families in Ontario, Algonquian and Iroquoian, differ and are therefore listed separately.

Sentence Structure

In Native languages, sentences are structured in a variety of ways that may include one or more of the following parts of speech: verbs, nouns, pronouns, particles, and conjunctions.

A verb and its affixes, used to convey such grammatical information as person, number, and tense, can represent a complete sentence. Sometimes a particle can express a complete thought. Sentences may also consist of one or more clauses that in English would be parallel to simple, compound, complex, or compound-complex constructions.

Spelling Strategies

Use of:

- cluster and syllable recognition
- capitalization
- punctuation
- diacritical marks
- contractions as they occur in rapid speech (Iroquoian)
- resources to confirm spelling (e.g., classroom-displayed lists, texts, dictionaries, lexicons, information technology)

Vocabulary

Use of:

- basic vocabulary (*sample list*: numbers from 1 to 10 000; simple mathematical operations; kinship as it applies to ecology (Mother Earth); occupations; the arts – music, film, dance, theatre, painting; seasonal activities; social events; weather; government; community activities)
- new words from units of study and personal and class word lists
- a Native-English dictionary or lexicon to build vocabulary

Language Elements

Algonquian Language Family

Verbs

- *Type*
 - animate intransitive
 - inanimate intransitive
 - animate transitive
 - inanimate transitive
- *Tense*
 - present
 - simple past
 - intentional future
 - definite future
 - changed-form conjunct
 - dual
- *Person*
 - first, second, third
 - regular, irregular
 - proximate
 - obviative
 - animate intransitive
 - animate transitive
 - inanimate intransitive
 - inanimate transitive
- *Number*
 - singular
 - plural
- *Order*
 - imperative
 - simple direct commands
 - delayed
 - independent
 - simple statements
 - conjunct
 - interrogative
 - compound sentences
 - complex sentences
 - compound-complex sentences
 - conditional sentences
 - dubitative

• *Negation*

- yes/no questions
- simple negation
- prohibition

• *Voice*

- active
- passive

Nouns

• *Type*

- locative
- diminutive
- possessive
- dependent
- pejorative
- vocative
- preterit

• *Gender*

- animate
- inanimate

• *Case*

- subject
- object

• *Number*

- singular
- plural

• *Person*

- third
- proximate
- obviative

Pronouns

• *Type*

- personal
 - dependent
 - independent
- interrogative
- demonstrative
- possessive
- indefinite
- reflexive
- dubitative

• *Number*

- singular
- plural

• *Person*

- first, second, third
- proximate
- obviative

Particles

• *Type*

- question particles
- conjunctions
- quantifiers
- adverbs indicating time, place, manner, degree

Language Elements

Iroquoian Language Family

Verbs

- *Classification*
 - subjective
 - stem classifications
 - objective
 - stem classifications
 - transitive
 - intransitive
 - irregular
- *Conjugations*
 - pronouns
 - first, second, third person
 - personal
 - singular
 - dual
 - plural
 - tense and aspect
 - imperatives
 - interactives
- *Incorporation*
 - prefixes, infixes, suffixes
 - with noun
 - in adjectival construction
 - in quantitative construction
 - pre-pronominal prefixes
 - cislocative
 - translocative
 - pre-pronominal prefix combinations
 - *te-* verbs (Mohawk)
 - *de-* verbs (Cayuga)
 - negation
 - contrastive construction
- *Irregular verbs*

Nouns

- *Classification*
 - formal
 - functional
 - animate
 - inanimate
- *Independent possessives*
 - singular, dual, plural
 - use with locatives
 - use to indicate kinship
- *Independent pronouns*
- *Independent numeration*
- *Independent locatives*
- *Independent adjectives*
- *Incorporation*
 - numeration
 - possessives
 - with a verb
 - in adjectival construction
 - pluralizers
 - locatives
 - quantitatives
 - qualitatives
 - incorporation combinations

Sentences

- *Types*
 - simple
 - compound
 - complex
 - compound-complex
- *Gender agreement*
- *Creation of negatives*
- *Creation of questions*
- *Creation of comparatives*
- *Independent quantity statements*
- *Adverbial phrases*

Particles

- *Types*
 - question particles
 - conjunctions
 - quantifiers
 - adverbs indicating time, place, manner, degree